

**Privatized Sovereignty:
A Stratigraphy of Control Without Exposure**

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Abstract

In June 2026 the largest aerospace firm in the world sold shares to the public while its founder retained 82.4 percent of the vote through a class of stock that also elects a majority of the board (Space Exploration Technologies Corp. 2026). We treat the founder-controlled public corporation as a well-documented case of lost self-correction, measured by the wedge between voting control and economic exposure. In a simple model the wedge finances its own persistence: a controller whose economic stake is below 0.42 rationally keeps control that destroys firm value, because the private benefits of control exceed the controller's share of the loss, and the Ford family's stake of 0.018 lies a factor of 24 inside that threshold. A lifecycle model calibrated to the documented 6-to-9-year fade of the dual-class premium places the crossover at 7.1 years; over 25 years a perpetual wedge loses 0.52 units of value against a single-class baseline while a renewable sunset gains 0.67. A model of competition among listing venues reproduces 61 years of holdout under low demand and a ratchet ending at 20-to-1 share classes without sunset, where London and Hong Kong arrived in 2024 and 2026. A correction model comparing 5 control architectures under identical controller failure finds the sealed wedge best in normal times and worst in failure, reaching irrecoverable damage in 39 percent of episodes against at most 0.45 percent where controllers can be removed; transparency alone recovers 12 percent of the damage and removability 46 percent. Comparison with Singapore, China, Japan, Korea and India locates the pathology in hierarchy protected from correction.

Introduction

The relevant filings are public. Snap's public shareholders hold a class of stock with no vote; the 2 founders control over 99 percent of the voting power, each holds a proxy over the other's shares effective on death or disability, and a 2016 dividend of non-voting shares allows the founders to sell economic interest without reducing control (Snap Inc. 2026). Meta's founder holds 60.8 percent of the vote through 99.8 percent of a 10-vote class (Meta Platforms, Inc. 2026). Alphabet's 2 founders jointly hold 52.7 percent, at 27.4 and 25.3, while an entire publicly traded class has no vote (Alphabet Inc. 2026). Palantir's charter sets the founders' Class F stock to a computed quantity, 49.999999 percent of the vote on covered matters less the founders' other votes (Palantir Technologies Inc. 2026). Ford's family class is fixed at 40 percent of the general vote and represents 1.8 percent of the shares outstanding (Ford Motor Company 2026). In June 2026 SpaceX priced the largest listing of its era with its founder at 82.4 percent of the vote, holding 91.6 percent of a Class B that separately elects 51 percent of the directors, with an economic stake of roughly 46 percent that falls with every sale (Space Exploration Technologies Corp. 2026).

None of these structures is hidden. Each is disclosed as the law requires, priced by the market and copied by later filings. A company can be public in its financing, its systemic consequences, its subsidies and its pension exposure while remaining private in its constitution. In these cases, going public means that the firm socialized its financing and kept its governance personal.

Legal visibility of structural change

Legal institutions are designed to recognize acts: a violent crime has a perpetrator, a date, a location and a statute. Structural transformation has none of these. Voting power separates from ownership through a sequence of individually lawful filings; infrastructure becomes dependent on one company through a sequence of individually rational contracts; an agency loses its engineers one resignation at a time. Every step is disclosed and none is unlawful, yet the aggregate is a constitutional change on which no institution voted.

The state is therefore strongest against concentrations of power that take the form of a crime and weakest against the same concentration in the form of a contract. The wedge grows inside the legal order and uses its categories of consent, property and disclosure, so the order has no category for it. An order in this condition lacks the vocabulary to describe its own transformation.

The wedge between voting and economic interest

Classical ownership joined 4 things: whoever received the profits also absorbed the losses, chose the directors, directed the enterprise through them, and bore the consequences. The founder-class charter separates them. Economic ownership goes to the public, voting control stays with the founder, operational authority follows the votes, and external consequences fall on users, workers, contractors and states that hold no shares. The quantity to track is the wedge, voting share minus economic share. Ford's family holds 40 percent of the vote on 1.8 percent of the shares; SpaceX's founder holds 82.4 percent on roughly 46. Ten-vote and twenty-vote classes, the pyramids of East Asia (Claessens et al. 2000) and the crossholdings of the chaebol are variants of one instrument, and concentrated control is the norm worldwide (La Porta et al. 1999).

The cost was identified early. One share, one vote forces anyone who wants control to bear a matching share of the consequences, which lets a control contest select the better manager (Grossman and Hart 1988); a wider wedge breaks this selection. The evidence agrees: as insider voting rights rise above cash-flow rights, firm value falls (Gompers et al. 2010), cash is worth less to outside shareholders, acquisitions destroy more value and executive pay rises (Masulis et al. 2009). The private benefits that motivate the arrangement have been measured directly, as the premium paid for controlling blocks across 39 countries (Dyck and Zingales 2004).

The wedge also finances its own defense. Let a controller hold economic stake α , let control yield a flow of private benefits, and let conversion to market governance raise firm value by some amount per year. The controller internalizes α of the improvement and all of the private benefit, so control is kept whenever the benefit exceeds α times the forgone value. In the model below the threshold stake is 0.42: a controller holding less rationally retains control that destroys firm value, and the smaller the stake, the cheaper the retention. The Ford family's 0.018 lies a factor of 24 inside the threshold. The SpaceX founder's 0.46 lies just above it and moves toward it with each sale. Entrenchment is therefore self-reinforcing: selling economic exposure strengthens the incentive to keep control, and keeping control makes the remaining exposure safer to sell.

The managerial corporation and one share, one vote

The first historical layer is the managerial corporation. Berle and Means described a corporation whose owners had dispersed and whose managers ruled in their name (Berle and Means 1932). That arrangement had its own agency problem and its own counterweights: unions, banks, regulators, antitrust law, and an exchange that made proportional voting a condition of admission. The New York Stock Exchange refused to list non-voting common stock from 1926 and formalized one share, one vote as policy in 1940 (Seligman 1986). Access to the deepest capital market required giving capital a vote, and for half a century issuers accepted that condition.

The contractual view and the end of the voting floor

The second layer was intellectual. From the 1970s the corporation was described as a nexus of contracts among shareholders, managers, creditors and workers, with the state's role reduced to disclosure and the prevention of fraud (Jensen and Meckling 1976). Under this description unequal votes become a disclosed and priced term, and the question shifts from whether a public corporation should permit control without ownership to whether the buyer was informed.

Institutions followed. Facing competition from venues that had never adopted the norm, the New York Stock Exchange moved to abandon one share, one vote in 1986 (Seligman 1986). The Securities and Exchange Commission responded in 1988 with Rule 19c-4, a floor under shareholder voting rights, and in 1990 a court struck the rule down as beyond the agency's authority (*Business Roundtable v. Securities and Exchange Commission* 1990). The resulting settlement allows a company to sell shares with reduced votes at listing while forbidding it to remove votes from shares already sold, so an expropriation prohibited in year 5 is standard at year 0.

Founder control and the dual-class premium

The third layer brought the founder to the centre. Venture capital made money abundant relative to exceptional companies, so those companies chose among investors and set governance terms. Software allowed firms to reach scale without the factories that once forced early listings, so founders arrived at the exchange with bargaining power. A few large successes supported the view that insulation caused success, while failures delisted and left the survivors as the sample. The view holds for a time: dual-class firms carry a valuation premium at listing that turns into a discount roughly 6 to 9 years later (Cremers et al. 2024). The case for perpetual insulation fails on its own terms, because a rationale based on one founder's ability cannot survive the founder's decline, departure or heirs (Bebchuk and Kastiel 2017). In 2018 institutional investors petitioned both major exchanges to require conversion within 7 years of listing (Council of Institutional Investors 2018). The petitions failed.

A lifecycle model of the wedge

The first of three models formalizes this layer. A controller starts with a knowledge advantage worth 0.30 units of annual value flow, which decays exponentially; insulation also imposes a con-

stant drag of 0.12, the sum of a 0.05 distortion from extraction of private benefits and the 0.07 a firm forgoes by excluding market discipline. Firms have 3 decay speeds, calibrated so that the population premium crosses zero at 7.1 years, inside the documented window. Figure 1 compares 5 charter regimes on this population over 25 years. The perpetual wedge captures the early premium and then follows the decayed advantage down, ending 0.52 units below a single-class baseline. An event sunset, conversion on the founder's departure at a 5 percent annual hazard, ends 0.1 above the baseline, because departures mostly arrive after the crossover. A hard 7-year sunset captures the premium and converts, ending at 0.62. A renewable sunset, extending insulation at 5-year intervals when unaffiliated shareholders see a demonstrated advantage, follows each firm's own crossover and ends at 0.67, the best result, because it retains insulation for slowly decaying founders and releases the rest. In this model founder insulation has real value during its documented window, and every regime that respects the window outperforms every regime that ignores it.

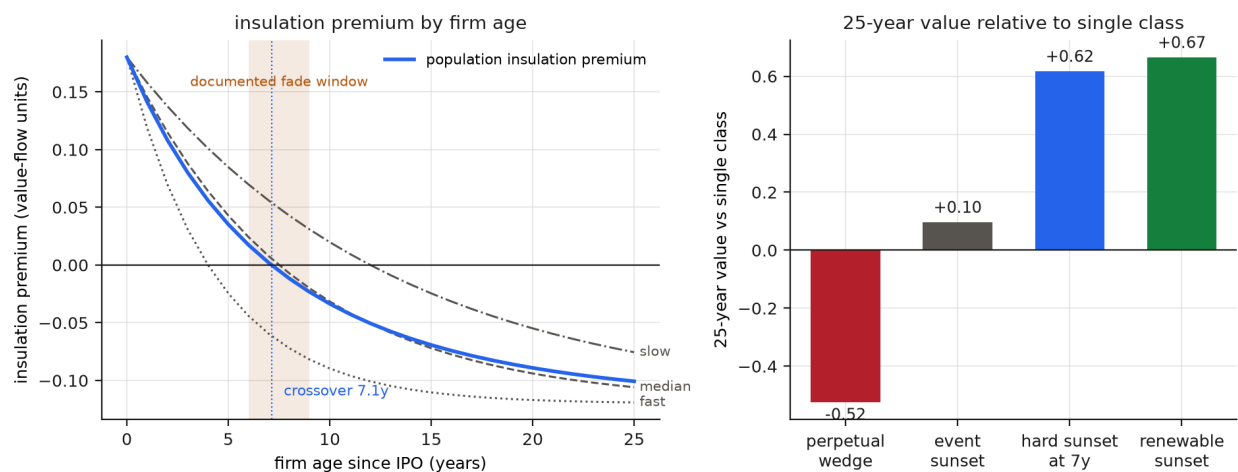


Figure 1: Lifecycle of the wedge. Left: the insulation premium decays through the documented 6-to-9-year window while the drag of insulation does not; the population crossover is at 7.1 years. Right: 25-year value relative to a single-class baseline; the perpetual wedge loses 0.52 and the renewable sunset gains 0.67.

Platforms as governing institutions

The fourth layer changed what the insulated firm is. A platform is an environment in which other agents act: it sets rules, adjudicates disputes, sanctions violators, manages identity and provides infrastructure, the functional profile of a government (Rahman 2018). When such a firm also carries the wedge, billions of people live under rules set by an organization whose own shareholders cannot outvote its founder. The dependence runs in both directions, since the state that would regulate the platform also buys its cloud services, launches on its rockets and uses its models. A regulator can hold legal authority while lacking any operational substitute for the regulated firm, and a firm in that position has the bargaining power of a strategic territory, which enters every enforcement decision.

Index ownership and consent

The fifth layer removed a remaining counterweight. The theory of shareholder consent assumes a shareholder who reads, votes and sells in protest. The actual owner of the American corporation is often a pension saver whose index fund holds the vote. Three asset managers held a median stake of 21.9 percent in the 500 largest listed firms at the end of 2021 and cast 24.9 percent of the votes at their meetings (Bebchuk and Hirst 2022); retail investors voted 28 percent of their shares in the 2025 season, the lowest in 9 years (Broadridge 2025). In Hirschman's terms, exit is unavailable to a fund that must hold the index and voice is delegated twice (Hirschman 1970). The saver chose a diversified product, the index chose the constituent, the fund inherited the vote, and the company cites market demand as evidence of consent. Consent passed through this many intermediaries is a legal construct performing constitutional work.

Competition among listing venues

The sixth layer is jurisdictional. A corporate constitution is now a product that venues sell in competition, and the competition moves in one direction. The United Kingdom's 2024 listing reform admits founder super-votes with no sunset and no cap on the ratio (Financial Conduct Authority 2024). Hong Kong, which had capped weighted voting at 10 to 1 since 2018, halved its market-capitalization thresholds in July 2026 and now permits 20 votes per share at the top tier (Hong Kong Exchanges and Clearing 2026). Listing revenue accrues to the venue while the governance cost is diffuse, and no venue can maintain a standard from which its rivals sell exemptions. The structure resembles tax competition with charters as the base, and the proposed responses have reached Congress without producing a floor (Congressional Research Service 2021).

A model of listing-standard competition

The second model reproduces this history from 3 elements: founders who value insulation differently, venues that abandon a shared norm when a rolling window of lost listings crosses a threshold, and demand for insulation that rises when intangible capital strengthens founders' bargaining power. While demand stays at its initial level, the restrictive incumbent loses a small number of listings and the norm holds for 61 model years, matching the half-century the New York Stock Exchange held it (Figure 2). Demand rises in the venture era and the incumbent defects 7 model years later, at model year 1987. The federal floor then keeps new domestic wedges at zero until it is removed, after which the cascade completes immediately; in the era of internationally mobile listings the restrictive foreign venues defect in model years 2020 and 2024; and once every venue is permissive, the degree of permissiveness rises to its maximum and does not fall, the 20-to-1, no-sunset endpoint in the documents. Two counterfactuals follow. With demand held flat the norm survives the century, so the race requires rising demand and cannot be explained by exchange behaviour alone. With the floor kept, domestic wedges stay at zero while about a tenth of demand moves to venues outside the coordinated zone, so coordination works imperfectly at a cost that is small relative to the cascade it prevents.

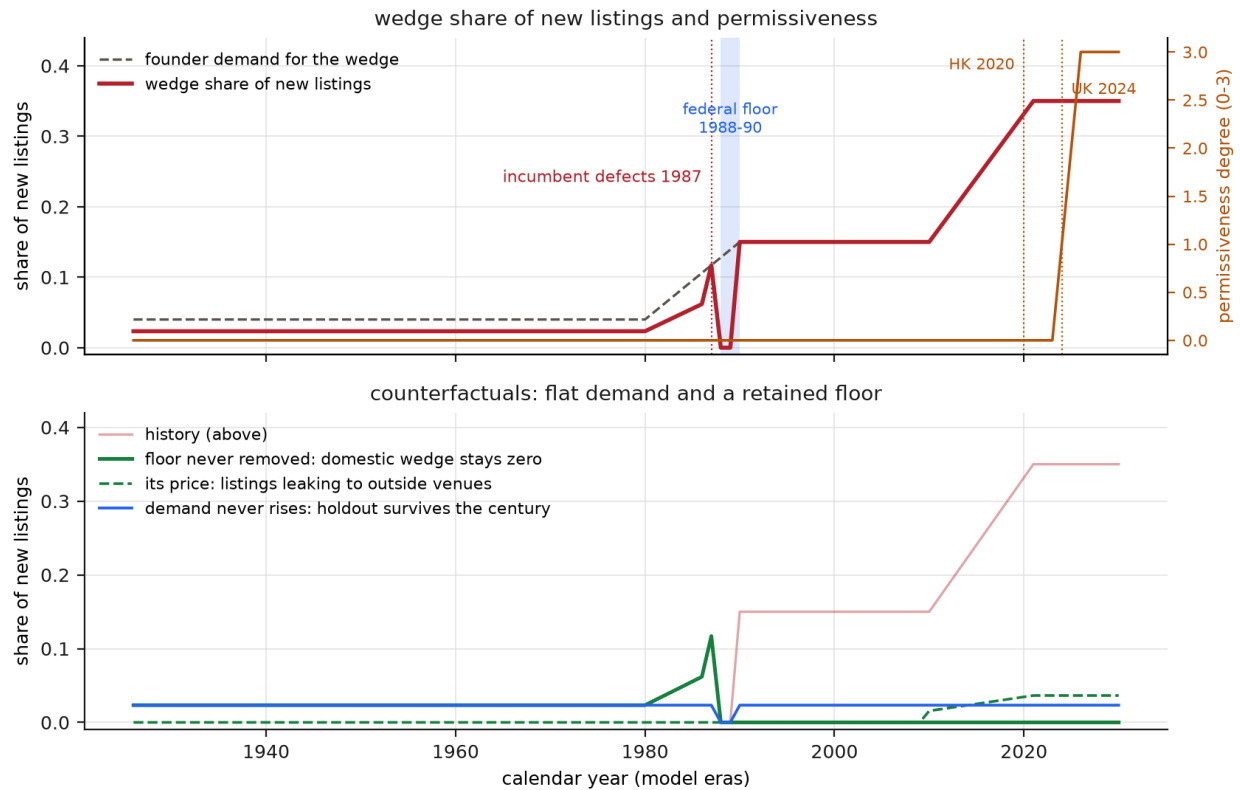


Figure 2: Competition in listing standards. Top: 61 years of holdout under low demand, defection 7 years after demand rose, the federal floor binding until removed, the foreign venues defecting in 2020 and 2024, and permissiveness rising to its maximum. Bottom: with demand flat the norm survives the century; with the floor kept, domestic wedges stay at zero and a tenth of demand moves abroad.

Dimensions of comparison

Whether the wedge matters is a comparative question, and the relevant comparison is with Asian systems, which are more hierarchical than the American one and differ on the dimensions that determine whether hierarchy corrects itself. Five dimensions organize the comparison. Visibility: can an outsider identify the controller? Reciprocity: does the controller bear losses in proportion to authority? Mandate: for whose benefit is control supposed to operate? Removability: which institution can replace a failed controller? Informational correction: can subordinates report unwelcome facts without ending their careers? The American founder corporation scores low on the last four while presenting itself as having no hierarchy. Singapore names its controller in the constitution and India names its promoters in the securities code, while the American charter names a share class and relies on the idea of dispersed ownership to obscure the controller.

Five control systems

Singapore organizes hierarchy as custody. Temasek's board and chief executive are appointed and removed with the concurrence of the elected president, a constitutional arrangement tied to protecting the state's past reserves (Republic of Singapore 2020); the state owns the economic interest it controls, and government-linked companies under this arrangement have shown stronger governance and higher valuations than matched private peers (Ang and Ding 2006). The design separates the state as owner from the state as regulator and assigns succession to institutions. Its known weakness is elite closure: supervisors and supervised come from one small pool, so the reporting channel and the controller can fail together, a risk the correction model prices.

China subordinates the corporation to the party. Party organization inside the large business groups controls appointments and strategy through the nomenklatura system (Brødsgaard 2012), and the 2023 revision of the Company Law, effective July 2024, modernized capital rules, audit committees and controlling-shareholder liability within that political order (Standing Committee of the National People's Congress 2023). The system removes controllers quickly once the centre decides, and decides late, because selection for loyalty degrades the reports on which decisions depend. China makes the top of the hierarchy legible and the middle opaque, the reverse of the American arrangement, in which the middle is transparent and the top is obscured.

Japan organized control as a network. Cross-shareholdings, main banks and stable corporate shareholders insulated managers for 2 generations, an ownership pattern that formed and unwound across the twentieth century (Franks et al. 2014). The network dampened extremes in both directions, with rare spectacular failures and chronic modest underperformance. The current unwind is instructive: in March 2023 the Tokyo Stock Exchange asked every listed company trading below its cost of capital, over 40 percent of the market at the time, to publish a plan (Tokyo Stock Exchange 2023), and has maintained and sharpened the request since (Japan Exchange Group 2026). A 40-year-old control architecture is being dismantled by an exchange, a ministry and shareholders acting in the same direction, which shows that correction is possible and that it took four decades and a coordinated effort.

Korea concentrated control in families through crossholdings, and the measured cost is tunneling: mergers timed and priced to transfer value from minority shareholders to the controlling family (Bae et al. 2002). The 2025 amendments to the Commercial Act extended directors' duties to shareholders, mandated cumulative voting at large listed companies and required separate election of audit-committee directors, with provisions phasing in through 2026 (Republic of Korea 2025). Whether the reform takes effect or is absorbed procedurally remains open, and the falsification section below makes a prediction about it.

India names the controller. Its securities regime designates the promoter as a formal category, promoters hold roughly 50.1 percent of the value of the national exchange's listed companies (National Stock Exchange of India 2025), and an Indian promoter typically owns the cash flow they control, so the wedge is narrow even where the stake is large. Reciprocity restrains extraction without eliminating it; related-party transactions and group-level extraction persist, measured in the propagation of earnings shocks through pyramids (Bertrand et al. 2002) and addressed incompletely by a decade of minority-protection reform (Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development 2014). A promoter with 60 percent of the shares can still harm the other 40 percent, but bears most of the cost of doing so, unlike a founder holding 40 percent of the votes on 1.8 percent of the shares.

Hierarchy is present in every system, and the pathology arises where hierarchy is protected from correction, whether by a share class, a loyalty cadre, a crossholding network or a family pyramid. The American variant is distinctive in presenting itself as the absence of hierarchy.

Institutional decline through selection

Formidable institutions are rarely defeated from outside. They decline through selection: loyalty replaces competence, truthful reporting becomes costly to careers, intelligence conforms to what leadership expects, maintenance loses to prestige projects, and experienced staff leave with the institution's memory. Output holds for years on inherited capability, because the stock built by earlier stewards buffers current decisions, and the decline appears only when a crisis demands performance the stock can no longer supply. The mechanism is general. It has been described in terms of distributional coalitions (Olson 1982), of complexity with negative marginal returns (Tainter 1988), and of elites converting open access back into personal privilege (North et al. 2009).

The American state shows the pattern in its own records. Trust in the federal government stood at 73 percent when first measured in 1958 and at 17 percent in 2025 (Pew Research Center 2025). Delivery capacity has moved outside the civil service: the state's blended workforce of contract and grant employees now far exceeds its civil service, leaving a government that buys what it once did (Light 2019). The shift has measured costs. In-house public engineers reduce infrastructure project costs by materially more than their salaries (Liscow et al. 2023), and patent examiners grant more patents, of lower quality, to the firms that later hire them (Tabakovic and Wollmann 2018). Capture of this kind needs no bribery, since the regulated firm knows more than the regulator, pays more, and employs the regulator's future self. Combined with the wedge, the two declines compound: firms that cannot be corrected from inside face a state less able to correct them from outside.

A model of correction capacity

The third model makes the comparison computable. An organization has a capability stock of 10 that grows at 0.25 a year under a good controller. At a random year the controller fails and begins destroying 0.8 units of capability a year. Output conceals the failure while the stock lasts: outsiders observe nothing until capability falls below 6, and below 2 the organization can no longer regenerate, which the model calls defeat. The 5 architectures differ in their correction machinery: the fidelity with which internal reports reach those who can act, the probability that a detected failure leads to removal, and the controller's economic exposure, which drives self-correction. The sealed wedge suppresses reporting, removes almost no one, and exposes its controller to 10 percent of losses. The reciprocal majority owner is exposed at 60 percent. The state custodial architecture reports and removes well, and in 15 percent of episodes suffers elite closure, with the supervisory channel captured along with the controller. The party vertical removes controllers immediately once the centre learns of failure, learns late through reports filtered for loyalty, and in normal times removes some good controllers in campaigns. The network architecture halves the damage rate through mutual restraint, removes almost no one, and waits for an external reform push.

Figure 3 reports 4,000 failure episodes per architecture. The sealed wedge loses 5.35 units of capability per episode and reaches defeat in 39 percent of them, the worst tail in the set. The custodial architecture loses 0.89, with defeat in 0.375 percent of episodes (15 of 4,000). The reciprocal owner loses 1.28, correcting mostly through the controller's own exit, with defeat in 0.45 percent. The vertical loses 2.69, detecting failure after 3.6 years on average against 0.7 for the custodial architecture and then removing quickly, with no defeats. The network loses 4.41 over episodes lasting 13.5 years, with reform as its largest correction channel at 0.4 of episodes. Two results stand out. In normal times the sealed wedge is the best architecture, growing 4.5 against 3.45 for the custodial architecture, because insulation does buy speed while the controller is good, so the tail is invisible in calm periods. And in the decomposition, giving the sealed architecture free reporting reduces damage by 12 percent, giving it removability reduces damage by 46 percent, and giving it both reduces damage by 81 percent, into the custodial range. Transparency mandates without removal mechanisms address a problem the wedge does not have. The elite-closure result qualifies the custodial alternative: when its supervisory channel is captured, loss per episode rises more than fourfold, from 0.58 to 2.59, so custody is only as good as the independence of the custodians.

Observable correction events

The diagnosis predicts where repair will be visible. If it is correct, value moves at correction events, when a wedge closes or a correction channel opens: sunset conversions and their renewals, founder succession at wedge firms, the Japanese unwind as protected crossholdings are converted into distributed capital, and the Korean amendments as the first cumulative-voting boards elect their audit committees. Each event is dated, public and measurable, and each has a null result that would count against the diagnosis: conversions that move nothing, successions absorbed without repricing, unwinds hoarded as cash, and reforms complied with procedurally while families keep

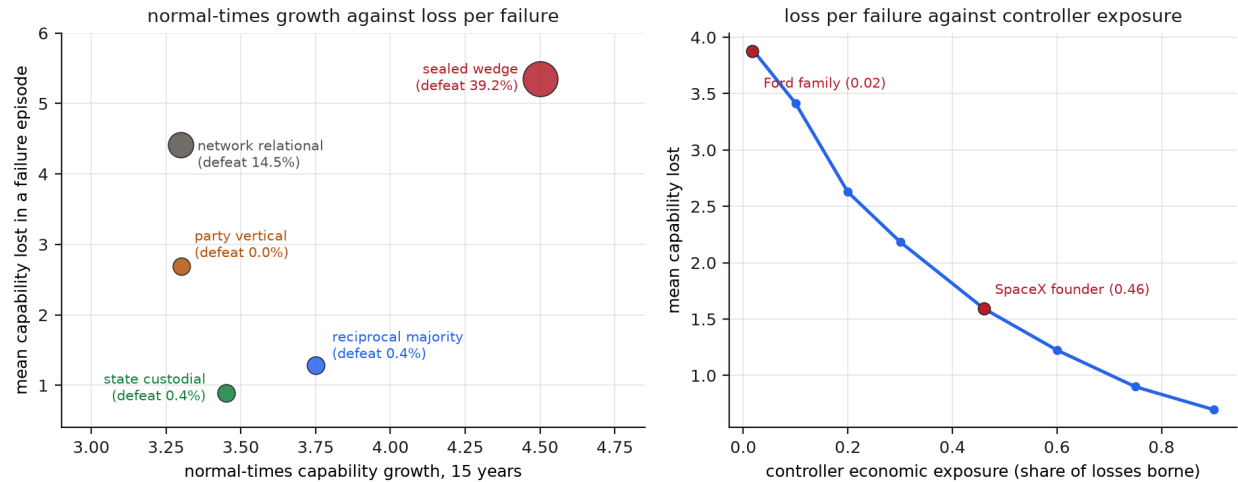


Figure 3: Correction capacity under 5 architectures. Left: normal-times growth against mean capability lost per failure episode; the sealed wedge is best in calm periods and worst in failure, with marker size showing the defeat rate. Right: economic exposure as a correction channel, with the measured Ford family and SpaceX founder stakes marked.

control by other means. These events define a research programme with falsifiers; nothing here is investment advice.

Proposed charter rules

The reform follows the models in 6 rules. Superior votes expire after 7 years, renewable by unaffiliated shareholders on a demonstrated advantage, because the renewable sunset ranks first in the lifecycle model. Superior votes convert on the founder's death, incapacity or departure, or when the founder's stake falls below a floor, because a rationale of exceptional ability cannot pass by inheritance and control with a low stake is self-perpetuating. Superior votes do not apply to controller pay, related-party transactions or charter amendments extending control, the domains in which the Korean and Indian records show extraction concentrating. Some directors are elected by unaffiliated shareholders alone, because removability does about four times the work of transparency in the correction model. Every offering prints a control statement on its cover, giving the ratio of votes to equity, the sunset terms and the matters public shares cannot reach, so that the wedge is legible at the point of sale. Firms performing sovereign functions (launch, cloud services, identity, communications) owe continuity: succession protocols, audit rights, and the state's retained capacity to reproduce the function, which requires the engineers the state has been losing (Liscow et al. 2023). None of these rules abolishes founder control; all of them bound its duration, where the evidence locates the harm.

Objections

The strongest case for the wedge is that markets are myopic, founders carry knowledge boards cannot absorb, and radical projects need patience that quarterly capital will not provide; the lifecy-

cle model grants a real premium worth 0.30 units at listing. This argument defeats a ban but not a sunset, because each of its premises is bound to a time and a person, and a renewable sunset keeps insulation as long as unaffiliated shareholders can see it working. A deeper objection concerns commitment: a founder may create value by credibly promising a 30-year horizon, which a 7-year review truncates. The renewable design answers most of this, since a demonstrated advantage renews; the remainder, projects whose value is real but invisible at every review, is a cost the rules accept in exchange for closing a tail in which 39 percent of sealed failures end in defeat. A third objection is that Asian hierarchies are worse, more coercive and less open to appeal. Sometimes they are, and the comparison records where; its purpose was to isolate the correction variable, and it recommends no model for emulation. Finally, the models are stylized: the lifecycle drag, the defection thresholds and the correction rates are structural assumptions without empirical estimation, so the claims concern orderings, crossovers and decompositions that survive changes in parameters, with every constant published and every invariant tested on each run.

Falsification

The diagnosis is empirical and fails under the following conditions. It fails if perpetual dual-class firms matched on age and sector outperform durably beyond the window documented in the premium literature. It fails if wide wedges stop predicting the agency costs they currently predict, or if controller turnover at wedge firms tracks performance as closely as at single-class firms. It fails if passive ownership proves harmless, with stewardship substituting fully for exit and voice. It fails if the competition among exchanges reverses without coordination, with a venue voluntarily restoring one share, one vote and prospering. It fails if states rebuild delivery capacity while outsourcing further, breaking the link between dependence on contractors and informational capture. And it fails in Korea and Japan specifically if the reforms identified above as correction events are carried out with no measurable consequence for governance or valuation. Throughout, the loss of correction capacity is a testable condition: the sustained absence of error correction.

Conclusion

An order losing its capacity for correction can appear sophisticated: exchanges clear, satellites launch, models run, and institutions keep their names while correction mechanisms weaken through lawful filings. The founder-controlled public corporation is a small and precise instance: public capital under a private constitution, exposure sold while control is retained, inherited capability concealing the quality of current decisions, and mechanisms that could refuse converted into mechanisms that record consent. Three roles clarify the arrangement. A steward holds power for a term and answers for it; an owner holds what they paid for and bears its losses; a custodian holds what outlasts them, on conditions. The wedge creates a fourth role, a controller who holds without paying, governs without answering, and outlasts every correction mechanism except death, the one sunset the charters accept. The New York Stock Exchange adopted one share, one vote in 1940 and moved to abandon it in 1986. The models indicate that restoring bounded

control is worth its cost, and the history indicates that it will not be restored without deliberate coordination.

Reproducibility

The simulation, its 3 figures and every model number quoted above regenerate from one command in the repository (`simulation/run_all.py`; models 1 and 2 are expected-value arithmetic and model 3 runs on a recorded seed, bit for bit). 34 invariants fail the run if broken, among them the crossover lying inside the documented window, the rank of the renewable sunset, the entrenchment threshold and the measured stakes on either side of it, the holdout under flat demand, the floor binding until removed, the monotone permissiveness ratchet, the sealed wedge's opposite extremes in calm and failure, and the decomposition of transparency against removability. Verified filing figures enter `results.json` as cited records with their sources.

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